

A Day in the Life of a Quality Lead

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#TestBash

October 2025

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Scope

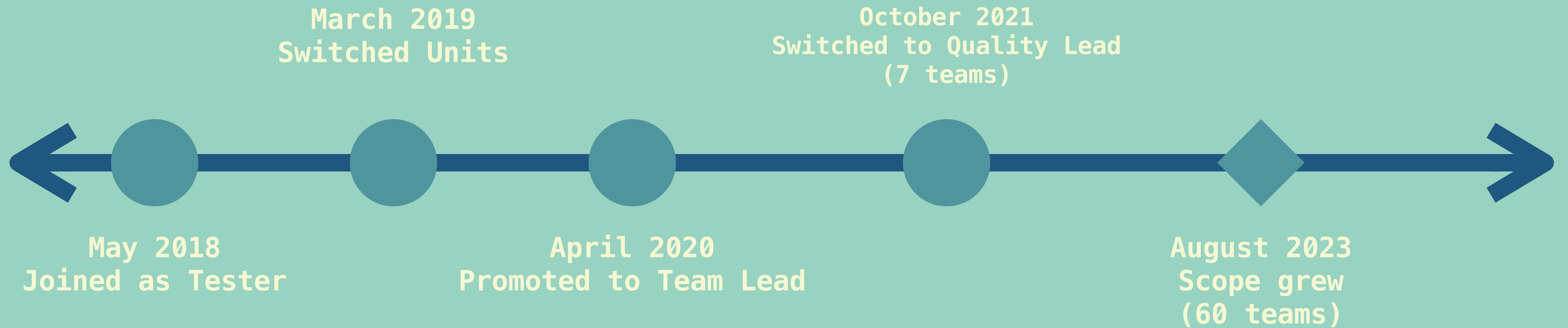
- Product Teams
- Self-organization
- Projects
- Wrap up

Context

Quick Facts

- 1500 people worldwide
- 1000 people in Rotterdam
- 500 people in R&D
(India & The Netherlands)





So good they can't
ignore you +
timing

Roles & Promotions

Context

Quick Facts

- 3 units
- Stationed in Cloud unit
- Boss in Compliance



Product Teams

August 2023
Login & Auth Team

Participating well
is leading by
example.

Product Teams



Ideas for Login & Auth Team

Sociocracy

- Safe enough to try
- Good enough for now

Ideas for Login & Auth Team

Agile Manifesto

- Software > docs
- Respond > plan

Ideas for Login & Auth Team

Onboarding

- Need more people
- Tiring

Ideas for Login & Auth Team

Sociocracy

- Safe enough to try
- Good enough for now

Experiments

- Vote on story, then stop
- Identify tasks to skip refinement

Agile Manifesto

- Software > docs
- Respond > plan

Experiments

- 1–2 hour mob to build mocks
- Stop calculating capacity

Onboarding

- Need more people
- Tiring

Experiments

- Schedule time off now
- Identify pain points for newbie

Ideas for Login & Auth Team

6 people x
30 min per week
=
3 hours per week

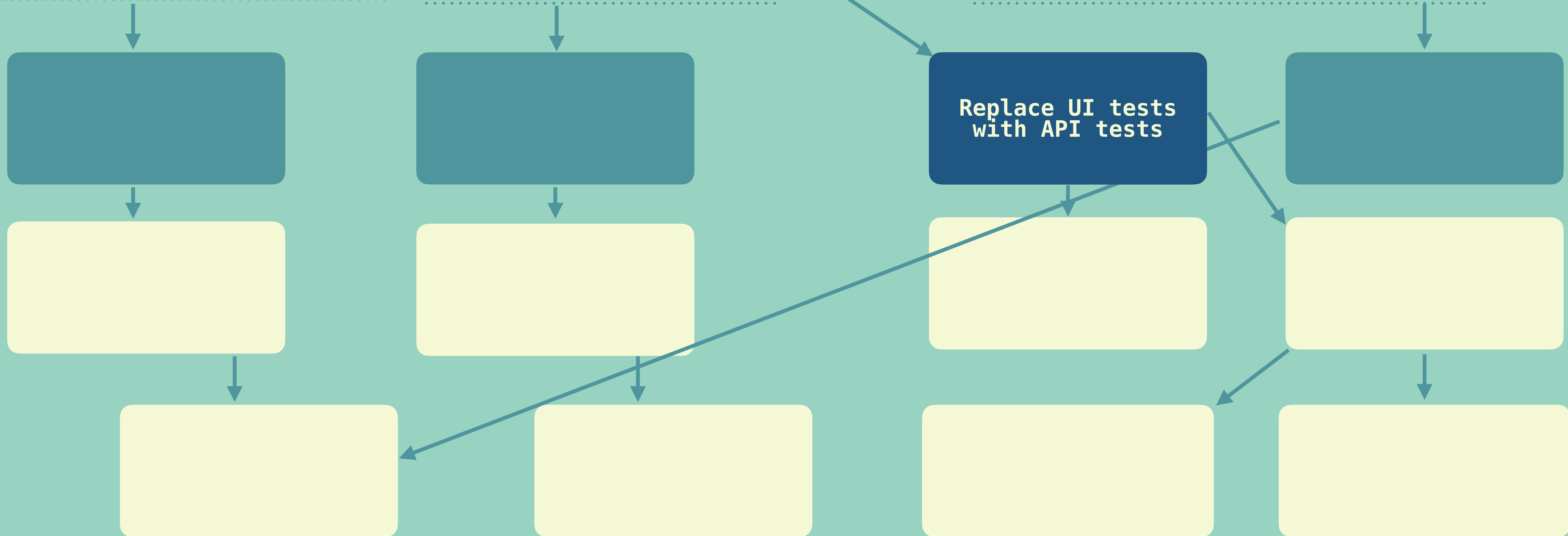
2 people x
1.5 days per release
=
3 days per release

No one burned out x
vibe of whole team
=
priceless

How did this occur?
How did we discover this?

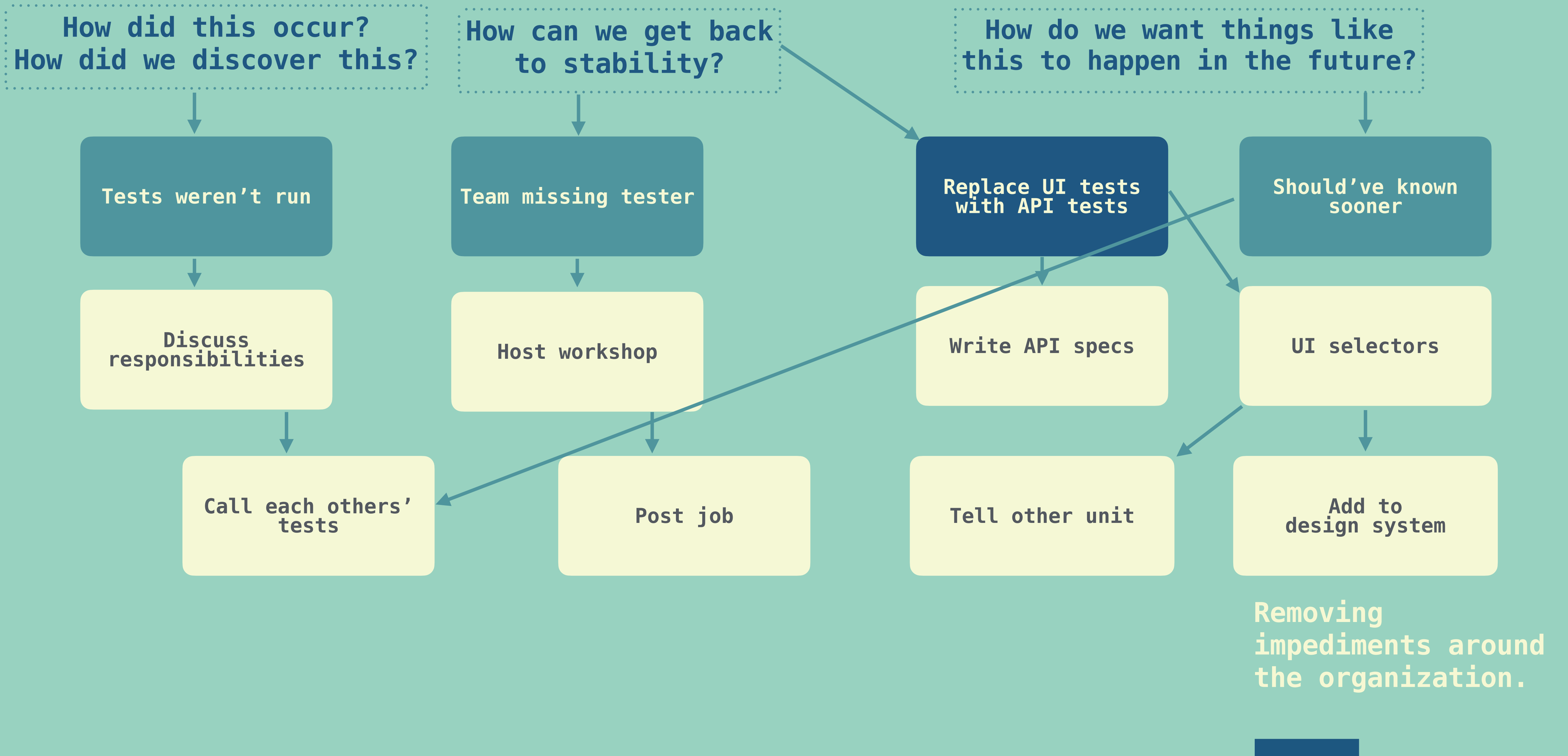
How can we get back
to stability?

How do we want things like
this to happen in the future?



Removing
impediments around
the organization.

What Leading Looks Like



What Leading Looks Like

January 2024
Deployment Team

August 2023

Participating well
is leading by
example.

Product Teams



Product Teams

Java BDD

- 45% to 85% passing
- UI selectors + data setup
- Dev wouldn't touch



Product Teams

Typescript & Playwright

- Building interesting skills
- Dedicated migration
- Devs would touch!



Product Teams

Code review

- Is this ready to review?
- What would happen if...?
- Will other tests need this?



January 2024
Deployment Team

August 2023

April 2024
+ Governance Team

Participating well
is leading by
example.

Product Teams



Releases

Smooth, fast, and boring

- Tests run and pass.
- Failing tests give info about the product.
- Passing tests means code goes to prod.
- On-call duties aren't draining.

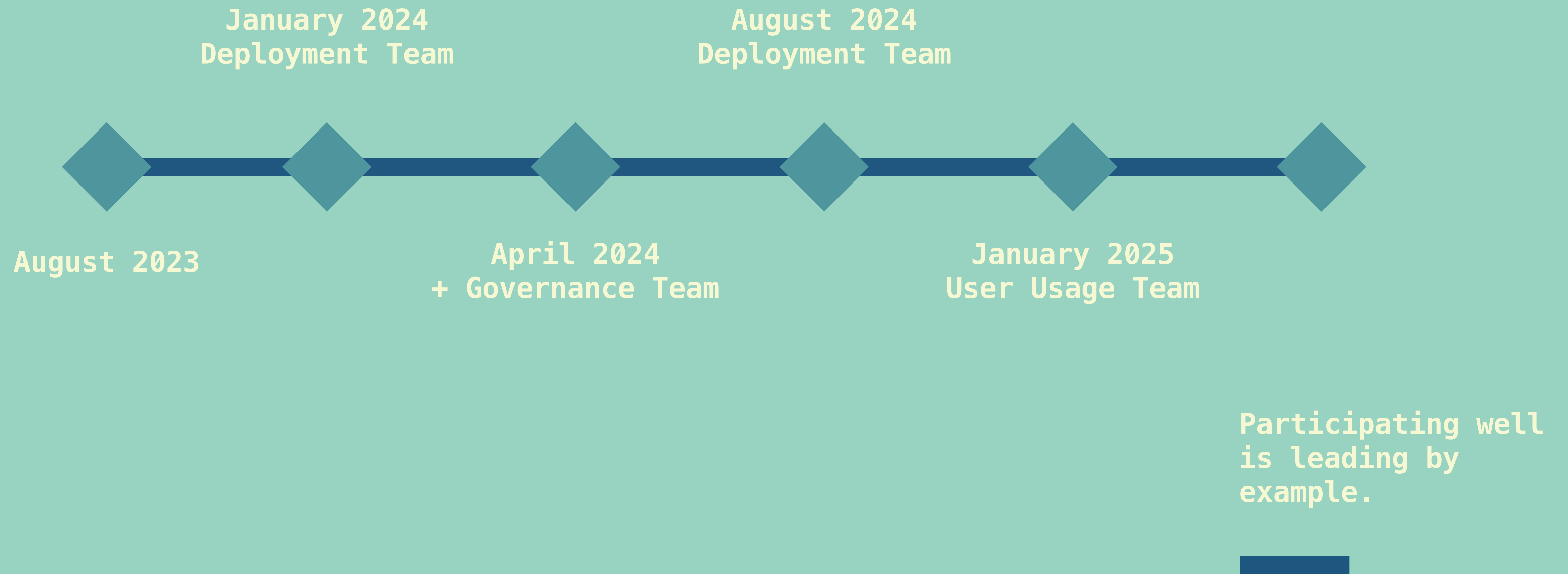


Product Teams

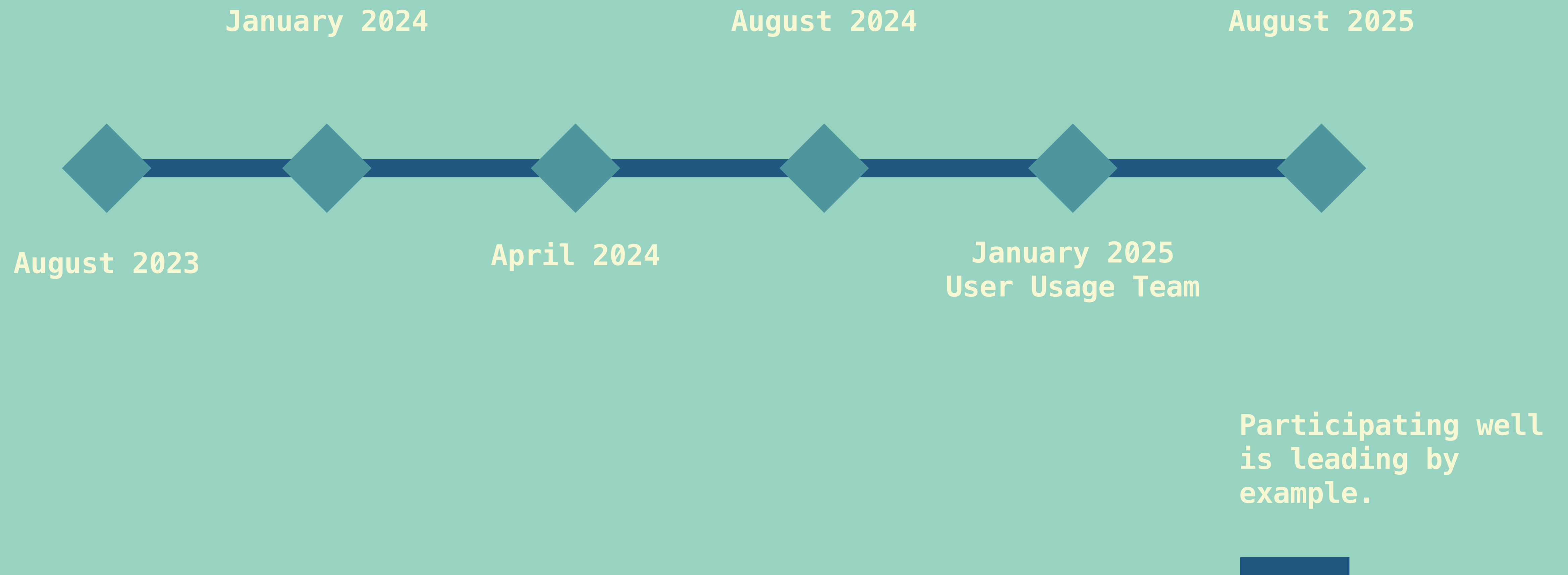
Product on fire

- Info not needed





Product Teams

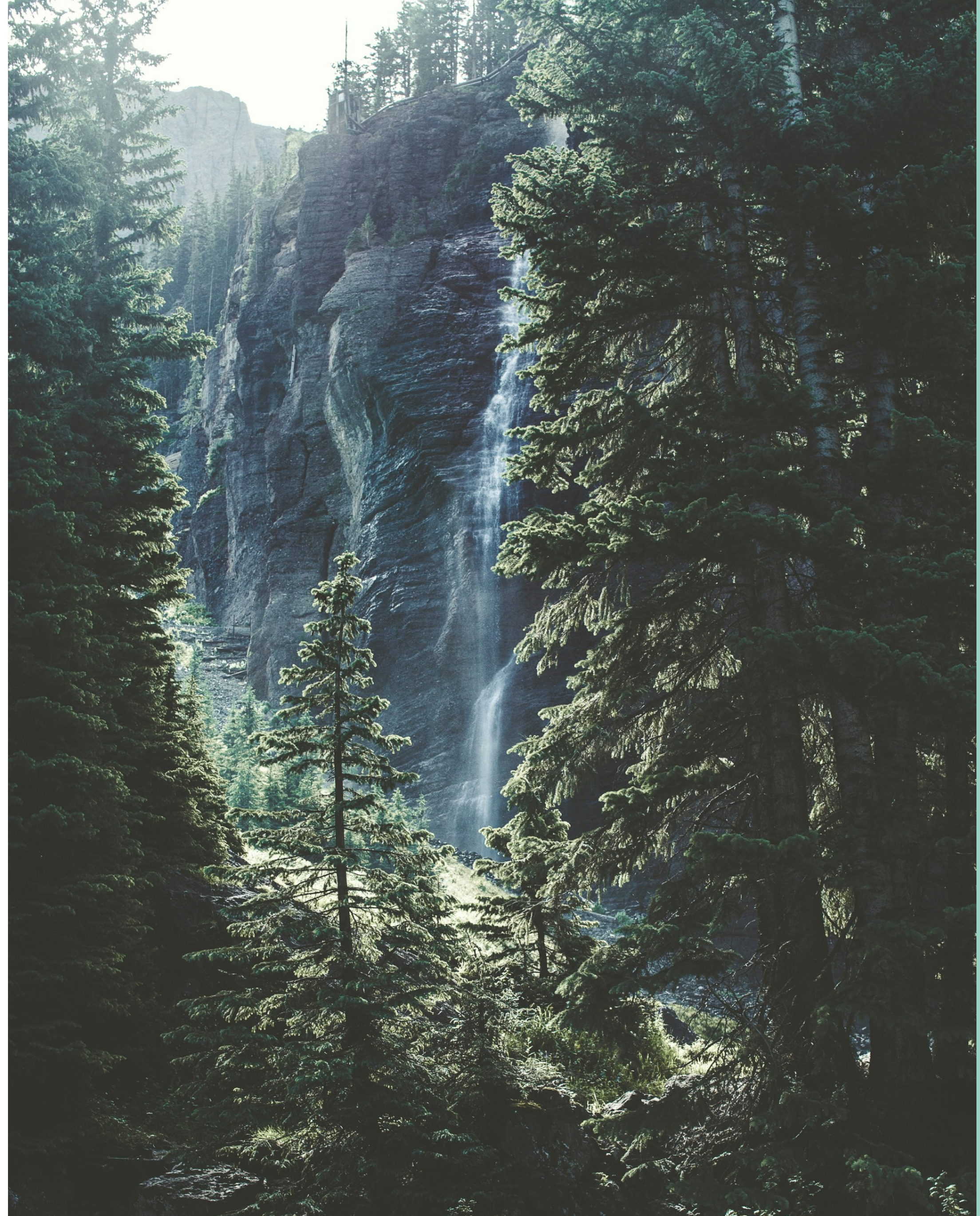


Product Teams

Product Teams

Favorite Questions

- Have you told them that directly?
- What's the next step?
- Have we seen this work once?
- What's the goal of this meeting?
- Should we write that down?
- Can we just start doing it?



Product Teams

Process lost

- Team doubled
- Scrum in shambles
- Stay in corner



Self-organization

Self-organization

Push Info Across

- Tell individual contributors what's happening



Self-organization

Push Info Up

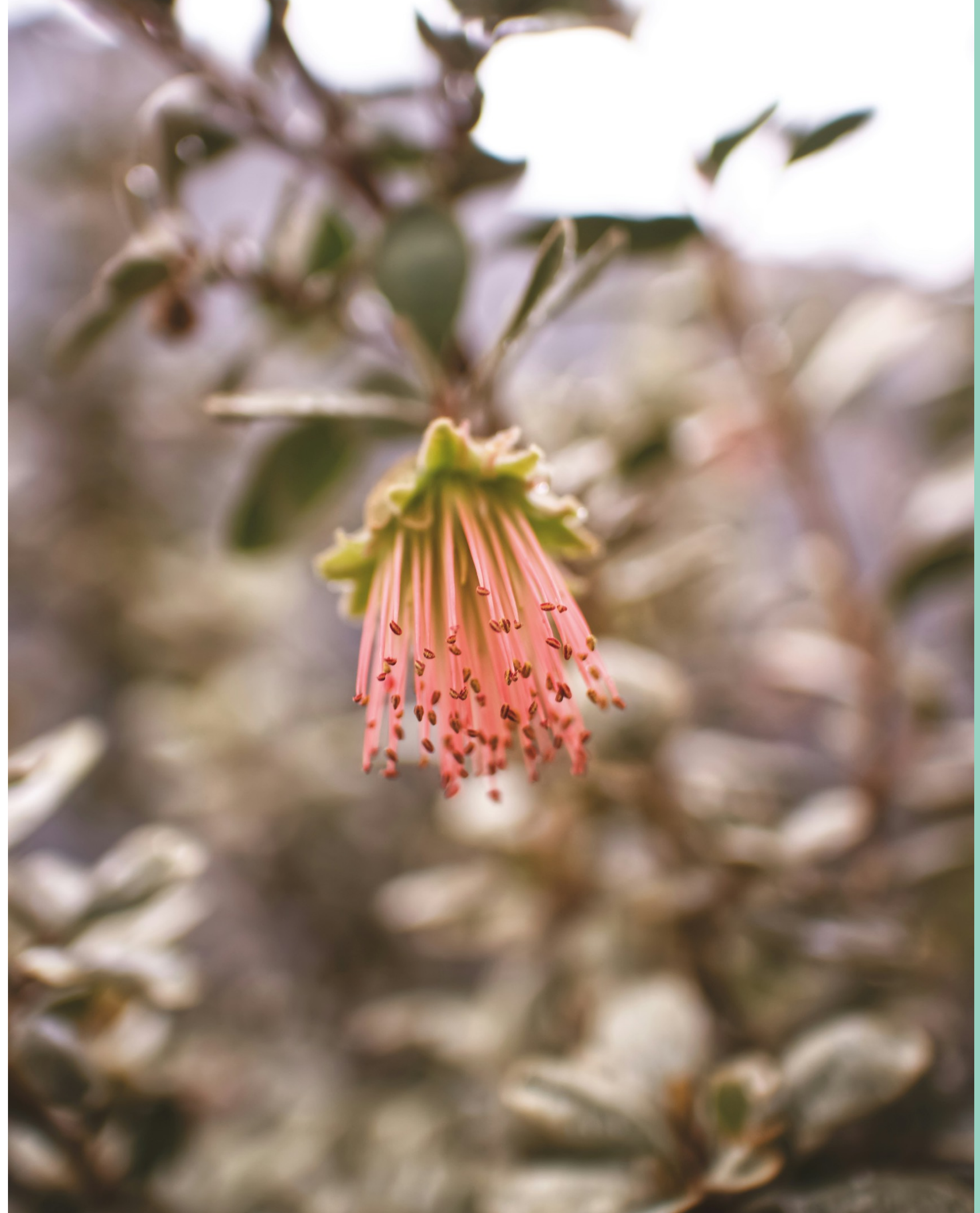
- Tell managers what's happening



Self-organization

Uniquely qualified

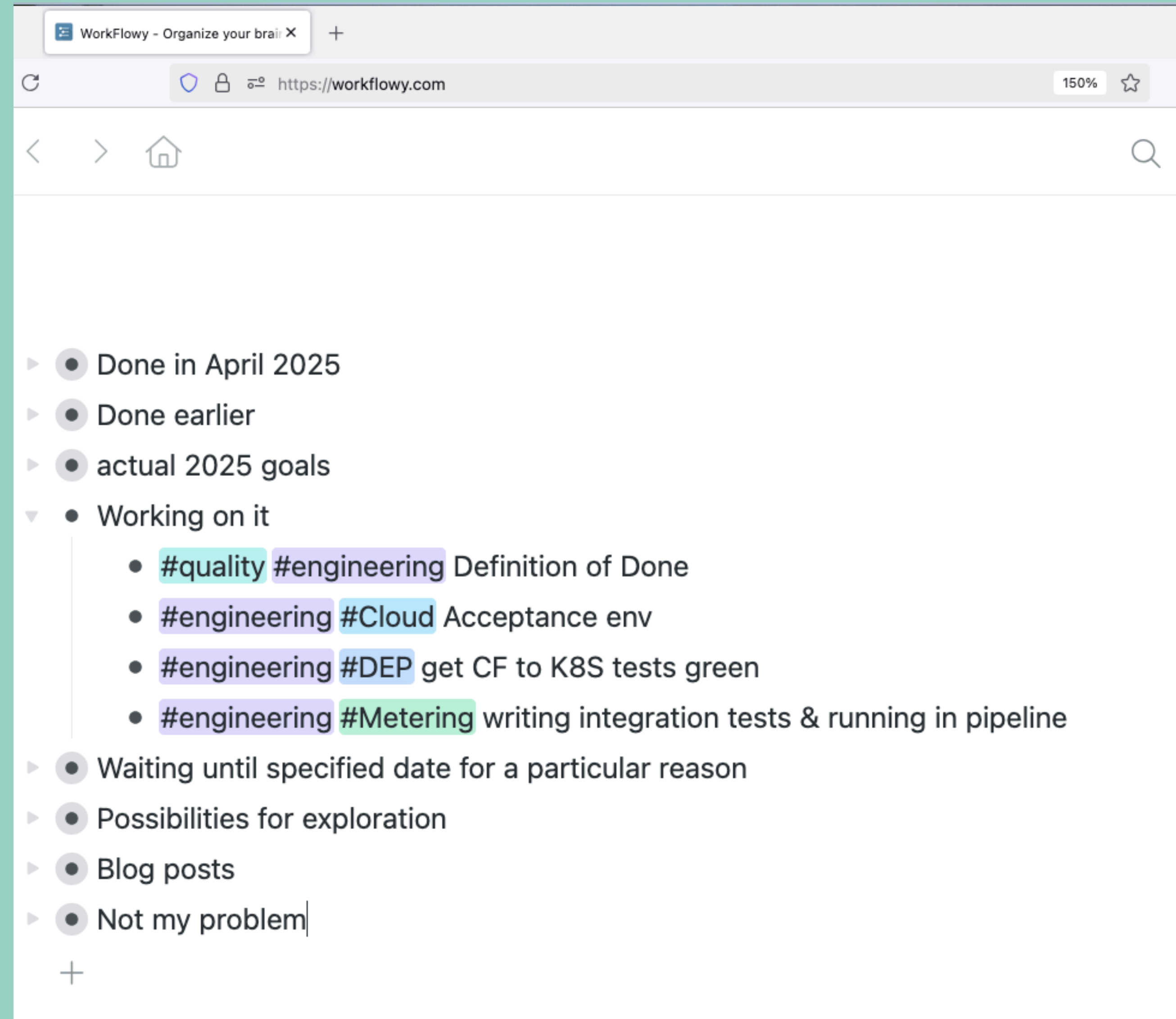
- Do we need an Elizabeth on this?



Self-organization

Priorities

- Accountable
- On track



Reflection

Tough stuff

- Letting things go



Self-organization

Putting work down

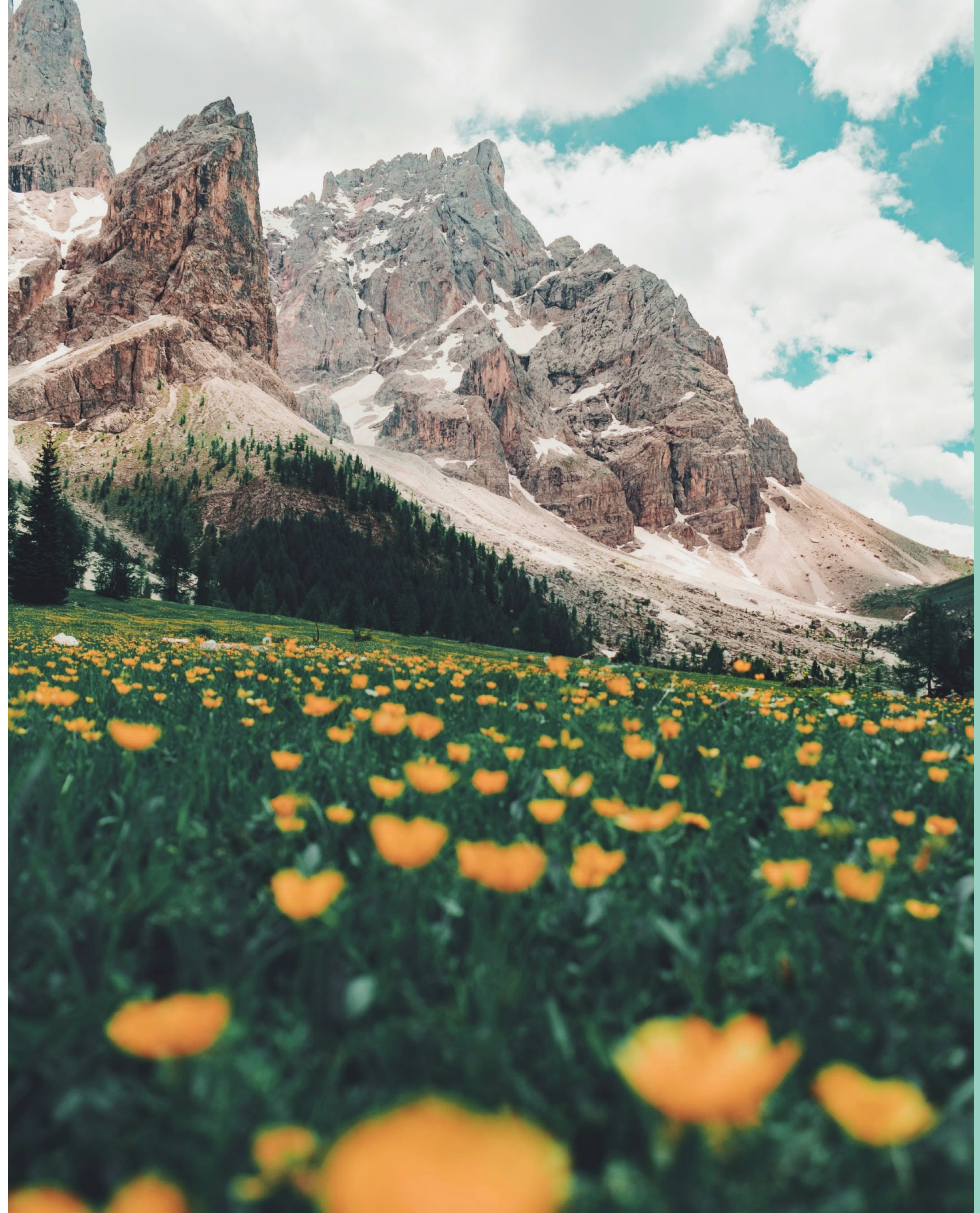
- Tell them
- Pair to handoff
- Give a reason



Self-organization

Picking projects up

- Sponsor / mandate
- Timeline / sad-line
- Goals / milestones



Projects

Projects

Buying a domain



Projects

Test Guilds



Projects

Accessibility

Further Side Quests

- (Leadership) Book Club
- Mocks and a Staging Environment
- Disaster Recovery Drill Days Planning & Communication
- Define Cloud Service Level Objectives
- Mentorship App for the Mothership
- Women in Product & Technology Speakers & Community
- Engineering-wide Definition of Done for Product Releases
- Hiring a (unicorn) tester
- Pipelines Workshop

Wrap up

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Lessons

- **Make work visible**

Lessons

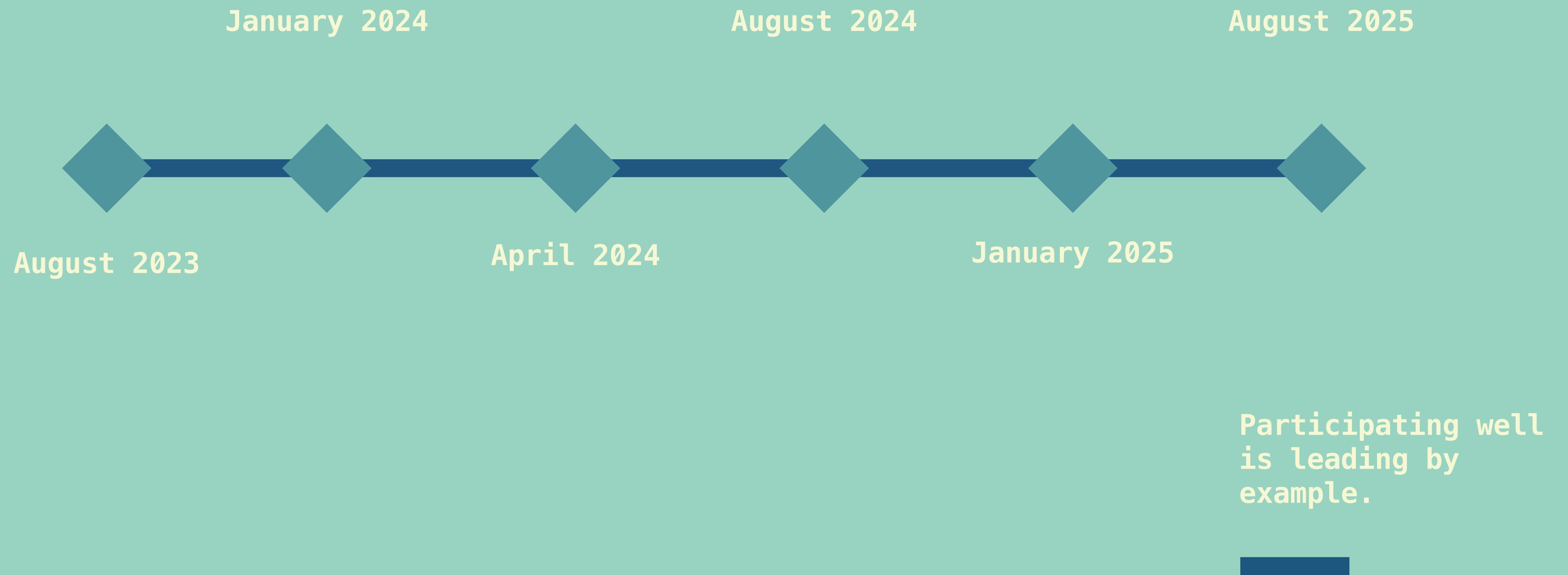
- Make work visible
- Not needed? Don't test!

Lessons

- Make work visible
- Not needed? Don't test!
- Collaborate

Lessons

- Make work visible
- Not needed? Don't test!
- Collaborate
- Tie to €€€ value



Product Teams

Choose

Thank you.

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